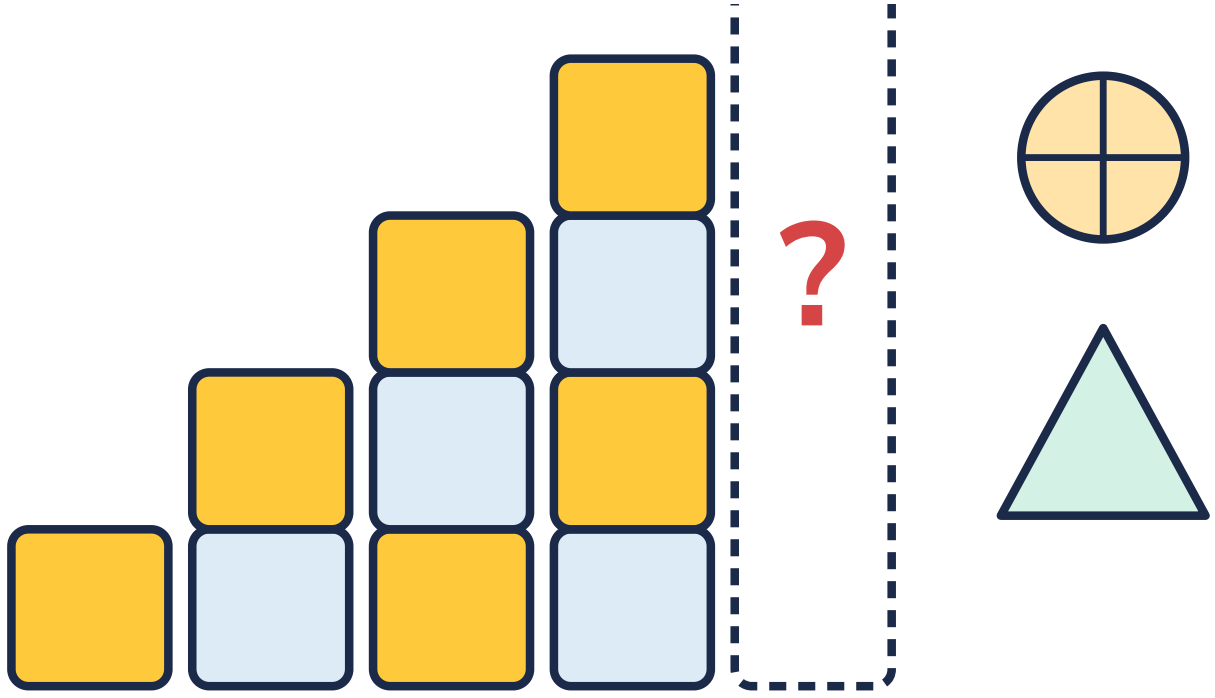
FOR PARENTS OF CHILDREN AGED 5 TO 6, ABOUT TO START PRIMARY 1

K2 Starter Pack

Short games to play at home, ten puzzles to try together, and what to expect from our friendly 15-minute readiness check. Buttons, spoons and blocks are all you need.



Notice it. Test it. Explain why.

From the Math Inquirers Holiday Program
Preciouslyours Pte Ltd

BEFORE WE MEET

1 The 15-minute readiness check

A short chat with a tutor over a few number games. Your child should feel they played, not that they sat a test.

15 minutes	Free	On video	You stay
one child at a time	we arrange it after you register	with counters at home	a grown-up sits beside your child

What the tutor will notice

COUNTING

Counting and numbers

- Counting out a number of counters, touching each one once
- Reading numbers to 20 and writing a few
- Counting on from a number, and back from 10

NUMBER SENSE

More, less and parts

- Which number is more, and how your child knows
- One more and one less
- Splitting 7 counters into two groups in more than one way
- Small adding and taking-away stories

THINKING

Patterns, shapes, reasons

- What comes next in a colour pattern or a counting pattern
- Naming a circle, triangle, square and rectangle
- Telling us how an answer was worked out, in words or with counters

WORKING

How your child works

- Staying with a game for about 15 minutes with small reminders
- Following a two-step request
- Having another go when something is tricky

What it is, and what it is not

- **It is not an entrance test.** There is no pass mark and no ranking, and your child is never compared with other children.
- **It helps us plan.** We use it to decide how to set up your child's place: which questions to start with, whether a little warm-up at home (like this pack) would be useful, and who might sit beside them.
- **It is about fit, not a grade.** If we think a later start would suit your child better, we will say so kindly and explain why. Many children simply enjoy it more after a term of Primary 1.
- **Wrong answers are welcome.** We say "Let's try another one". We stop early if your child is tired or upset.

After the check

Within a day we send **you** a short message: one thing your child did well and what we suggest next. We never message your child privately; the tutor speaks with you and your child together.

PLAY AT HOME, PART 1

2 Counting and number games

Five minutes is plenty. Little and often works better than one long session. Stop while it is still fun.

COUNTING TO 20, THEN 50

Count everything

Count steps, stairs, spoons, stones, lift buttons. Count to 20 first, then stretch to 30, 40 and 50.

The tricky bit: the jump to a new ten. Pause at 19, 29, 39 and ask "What comes next?" Count on from any number, not only from 1. Count back from 10, then from 20.

ONE-TO-ONE COUNTING

Touch it, move it, say it

Put 15 grapes or buttons in a heap. Ask: "Count out 12 for me." Your child touches each one once and moves it to a new pile, so none is counted twice or missed.

Then ask: "How many are left in the heap?"

NUMBER BONDS TO 5

Fingers and cups

Show 5 fingers. Fold some down: "How many are hiding?" Put 5 counters under a cup, show 2 and ask how many are under the cup.

Try 3 and 2, 4 and 1, 5 and 0. Notice that 3 and 2 is the same as 2 and 3.

NUMBER BONDS TO 10

The ten-frame

Draw two rows of 5 boxes (or use an egg box with 2 cups cut off). Put 7 counters in. "How many more to fill it?" Try every number from 1 to 9.

Say it as a story: "7 and 3 make 10."

NUMBERS 20 TO 50

Tens and ones

Make bundles of 10 spoons or pasta tubes with rubber bands. 3 bundles and 4 loose ones is 34. Ask: "Which is more, 34 or 43? How do you know?"

Look for numbers on doors, buses and lifts, and read them aloud.

WRITING NUMBERS

Big and slow

Write numbers in sand, flour or on the window with a finger first, then with a pencil. Take care with 6, 9, 12, 17 and 19. Starting at the top and checking "does it face the right way?" matters more than speed.

> **Ask "How do you know?" even when the answer is right. That is where the thinking is.**

PLAY AT HOME, PART 2

3 Patterns, shapes, lengths and blocks

These games need no workbook. Use things you already have: socks, spoons, leaves, boxes, building blocks or LEGO bricks.

PATTERNS

What comes next?

Make a row with socks or spoons: big, small, small, big, small, small, ... "What comes next? What will the 10th one be?" Clap and stamp patterns count too.

Then try a growing pattern with blocks: 1, 2, 3 blocks in towers. "How many in the next one?"

SHAPES

Shape hunt

Find a circle, triangle, square and rectangle around the home. Count the sides and corners together. Make shapes with straws or playdough.

Fold a sheet of paper in half and in half again. How many boxes when you open it?

COMPARING LENGTHS

Longer, shorter, same

Line up a spoon, a shoe and a pencil, starting at the same line on the table. "Which is longest? Shortest? How can we be sure?"

Then measure with blocks or paper clips laid end to end. "The shoe is 6 blocks long."

SPATIAL PLAY

Build it, then draw it

Build a tower of 5 blocks, and a wall of 3 rows. "How many blocks? How many can you see from the front? How many are hiding?"

Make a plan with numbers on squares: 3, 1, 2 means towers 3, 1 and 2 blocks tall. Can your child build it from the plan?

PAPER PLAY

Fold and cut

Fold a paper in half, cut a triangle from the folded edge, and guess before you open it: what will the hole look like? Draw a round pizza on paper and cut it with 1, 2 and then 3 straight lines. Count the pieces each time.

LEFT AND RIGHT

Turn and tell

"Put the cup on the left of the plate." Turn around and ask again: "Where is the cup now?" Act it out with a teddy.

Safety: keep small blocks, buttons, coins and dried beans away from younger brothers and sisters, and stay close while your child plays.

TALK AND PREPARE

4 Talking about maths, and what to bring

How to talk about maths at home

Try saying	Rather than
"What do you notice?"	"Look, it is 5."
"How do you know?" or "Show me with the blocks."	"Yes, well done" or "No, try again."
"Mistakes help us. What could we try now?"	"That is easy" or "That is wrong."
"I like how you checked that."	"You are so clever."
"I wonder what happens if we add one more."	Telling the whole method straight away.

- **Wait.** Count slowly to ten in your head before you help.
- **Use real things.** Counters and blocks make numbers visible.
- **Keep it short.** Five to ten minutes, then stop.
- **Use everyday moments.** "How many plates do we need?" "Which cup holds more?"
- **Notice it. Test it. Explain why.** Notice something, try it, then say how you know.

What to bring to the readiness check

SET OUT BEFORE WE START

Things to have ready

- About 25 counters: buttons, coins, dried beans or LEGO bricks (keep them in a bowl until we ask)
- A pencil and a sheet of paper
- A laptop or tablet with the camera and sound on, steady on a table, so we can see the table and your child's hands
- A quiet table and a glass of water

ON THE DAY

What helps

- A grown-up beside your child for the whole check, in view of the camera
- A rested, fed child. A morning or after a nap is often best
- A calm, light mood: "We are going to play some number games."
- Please do not coach or prompt answers. If your child is unsure, that is useful for us to see

You do not need to practise before the check, and nothing in this pack is a "must do". If your child plays a few of the games, they will meet the same kinds of ideas.

5 Try these together

PRACTICE PUZZLES, 1 TO 5

Read each puzzle aloud. Let your child use buttons, blocks or fingers. You do not need to do all of them in one go. Answers are on page 8: look after you have tried.

1 Count on. Write the missing numbers.

37 38 ☐ ☐ 41 ☐

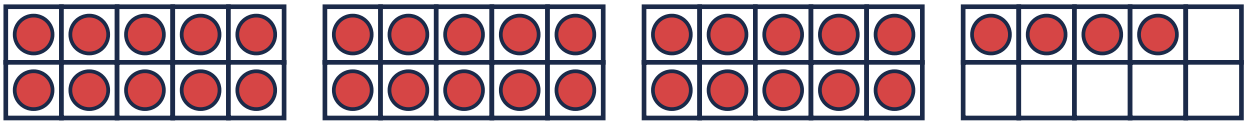
Say the numbers aloud as you go.

2 Put these number cards in order, **smallest first**. Which is the biggest?

41 29 35 24

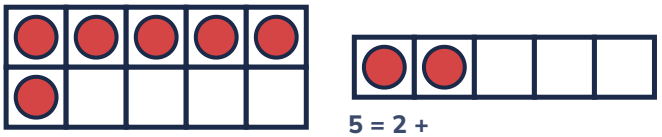
Smallest first: ____ ____ ____ ____ Biggest: ____

3 The red counters are in tens frames. **How many counters in all?** (Count the full frames in tens.)



In all: ____

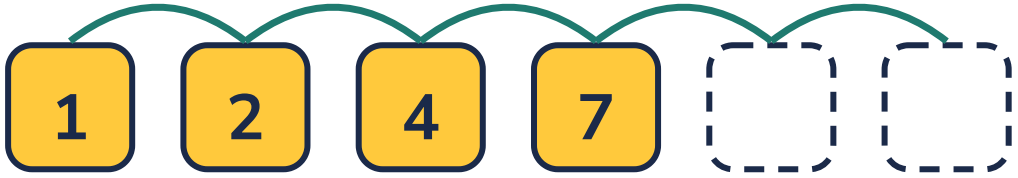
4 How many more counters make a full frame? Fill in the boxes.



10 = 6 + ____

5 = 2 + ____

5 The hops get **one bigger** each time. What are the next two numbers?



How do you know?

PRACTICE PUZZLES, 6 TO 10

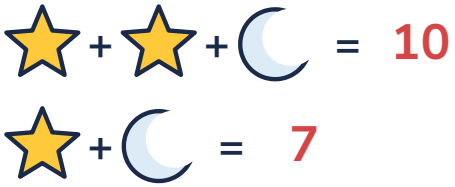
6 More to try together

6 Here is a bead pattern. **What colour is bead 11? And bead 12?**



R = red, B = blue, Y = yellow. Bead 11: _____ Bead 12: _____

7 Each shape is a secret number. **What is the star? What is the moon?** (Use the second line to help with the first.)



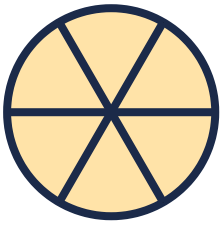
Star = _____ Moon = _____

8 Towers of blocks, seen from above. Each number is how many blocks tall. **How many blocks in all? How many more blocks make every tower 3 tall?**



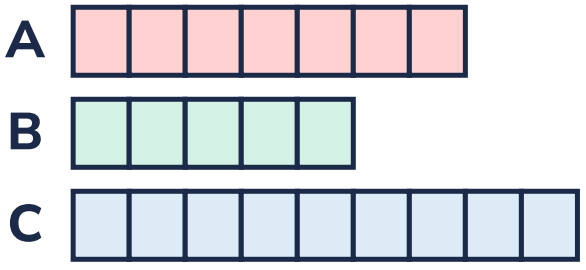
Build it with blocks to check.
Blocks in all: _____
More blocks needed: _____

9 A round pizza has 3 straight cuts, all through the middle. **How many pieces?** One more cut through the middle: **how many pieces now?**



3 cuts: _____ pieces
4 cuts: _____ pieces

10 Three ribbons are measured in blocks. **Which is longest? Which is shortest? How many blocks longer is the longest than the shortest?**



Longest: _____ Shortest: _____ Longer by: _____ blocks

LOOK AFTER YOU HAVE TRIED

Answers

A different way of thinking is fine, as long as your child can show or say how they know. Ask "How did you work it out?"

1. 39, 40, 42 (after 39 comes 40, a new ten)
2. 24, 29, 35, 41. The biggest is 41. Compare the tens first, then the ones.
3. 34 counters: 3 full frames make 30, and 4 more.
4. 4 (10 = 6 + 4) and 3 (5 = 2 + 3).
5. 11 and 16. The hops grow: +1, +2, +3, +4, +5.
6. Bead 11 is blue and bead 12 is yellow. The pattern repeats every 4 beads: red, red, blue, yellow.
7. Star = 3, moon = 4. Line 2 says star + moon = 7, so line 1 has one extra star: 10 - 7 = 3. Check: 3 + 3 + 4 = 10.
8. 8 blocks (3 + 1 + 2 + 2). Three-tall towers need 4 x 3 = 12, so 4 more.
9. 6 pieces, then 8 pieces. Every cut through the middle adds 2 pieces.
10. Longest: C (9 blocks). Shortest: B (5 blocks). The longest is 4 blocks longer.

If a puzzle was hard

- Use real things: counters for puzzles 1 to 5 and 7, blocks for 8, a drawing for 9, paper strips for 10.
- Try a smaller example first, then come back.
- Put it aside and try again next week. Being stuck is part of thinking.

What next?

We arrange the free readiness check after you register for the Math Inquirers Holiday Program. Ten 90-minute lessons in small live online groups, hands-on puzzles, and a printed workbook posted to your home.

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